

BLAMO CLOSING

Automotive sales training

F&I Awareness Training Manual

Helping Customers Transition to Finance with Confidence

Close with Clarity—Not Pressure

Helping Customers Transition to Finance with Confidence

Purpose

This manual helps salespeople prepare customers for a confident, informed transition into Finance & Insurance. Use it to build trust, explain the process accurately, and work as one team—without pressure.

How to use this manual

Read the chapters before your next shift, rehearse the scripts out loud, and use the checklists before every handoff. You are not the finance manager; your role is to make the next step clear and comfortable.

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Close with Clarity—Not Pressure

CHAPTER 1

Understanding the Role of F&I

Learning Objective

Understand how Finance & Insurance (F&I) supports both the customer experience and dealership profitability.

What Is F&I?

The Finance & Insurance department helps customers:

- ☐ Secure financing
- ☐ Review financing terms
- ☐ Complete paperwork
- ☐ Protect their vehicle investment
- ☐ Understand optional products and services

Salesperson's Role

You are not the finance manager.

Your responsibility is to:

- ☐ Build value in the vehicle.
- ☐ Prepare the customer for the finance process.
- ☐ Create confidence and trust.
- ☐ Introduce finance as the next step in completing the purchase.

COACH'S NOTE

Customers should view the finance office as a continuation of great service—not a surprise or an obstacle.

CHAPTER 2

Preparing Customers for Finance

Why It Matters

Customers who understand what comes next are more relaxed, cooperative, and satisfied.

Before the Handoff

Review:

- ☐ Vehicle selection
- ☐ Trade-in (if applicable)
- ☐ Purchase agreement
- ☐ Estimated payment
- ☐ Driver's license
- ☐ Insurance information

WHAT TO SAY

"Congratulations on your new vehicle! The next step is meeting with our finance specialist. They'll help finalize your paperwork, explain your financing options, and review available protection plans so you can decide what's best for you."

AVOID SAYING

- "They're going to sell you warranties."
- "You have to buy this."
- "I don't know what they do in finance."

Coaching Tip

Speak positively about the finance department. Customers often form their opinion before they even enter the office.

Customer Readiness Checklist

- ☐ Vehicle selected
- ☐ Numbers reviewed
- ☐ Trade appraised
- ☐ Insurance verified
- ☐ Driver's license copied
- ☐ Questions answered
- ☐ Expectations set

CHAPTER 3

Presenting Protection Products

Your Job Isn't to Sell F&I Products

It's to create awareness.

Common Protection Products

Vehicle Service Contract (Extended Coverage)

Benefit: Helps reduce unexpected repair costs after the factory warranty expires.

GAP Coverage

Benefit: May help cover the difference between the vehicle's value and loan balance if the vehicle is declared a total loss, subject to the terms of the coverage.

Tire & Wheel Protection

Benefit: Can help with repair or replacement costs for covered tire and wheel damage caused by road hazards.

Paint & Interior Protection

Benefit: Helps protect the vehicle's appearance and can make cleanup and maintenance easier.

Key Replacement

Benefit: Provides coverage for replacement of lost, stolen, or damaged keys when included in the protection plan.

CONVERSATION EXAMPLE

Customer: "I don't think I need any extras."
Salesperson: "That's completely your choice. Our finance specialist will explain the options available, and you can decide what makes the most sense for your situation."

Coaching Tip

Never pressure customers into purchasing protection products. Your role is to encourage informed decisions.

CHAPTER 4

Working with Finance Managers

Teamwork Builds Customer Confidence

Customers should see sales and finance as one team.

Best Practices

- ✓ Introduce the finance manager personally.
- ✓ Stay positive.
- ✓ Share important customer information.
- ✓ Avoid discussing financing details you're not authorized to explain.

Information to Share with F&I

- Customer Name
- Vehicle Purchased
- Trade Information
- Preferred Payment Range
- Special Requests
- Delivery Timeline
- Customer Concerns

BLAMO HANDOFF SCRIPT

"Sarah, this is Mike, our finance manager. Mike will help complete the final paperwork, review your financing options, and answer any remaining questions. You're in great hands."

COACHING NOTE

A warm introduction reduces anxiety and creates a seamless transition.

CHAPTER 5

Compliance Basics Every Salesperson Should Know

Why Compliance Matters

Following dealership policies and applicable laws helps protect:

- ✓ Customers
- ✓ Employees
- ✓ The dealership

Key Principles

- ✓ Be honest.
- ✓ Present information accurately.
- ✓ Respect customer privacy.
- ✓ Avoid making promises you can't guarantee.
- ✓ Treat every customer fairly and consistently.

Avoid Statements Like

❑ "You're guaranteed to be approved."
❑ "This warranty covers everything."
❑ "You have to buy GAP."
❑ "Everyone qualifies."

Instead say:

✓ "Our finance manager will review the available options with you."
✓ "Coverage depends on the specific plan selected."

Protect Customer Information

Never discuss:

- Credit scores
- Loan approvals
- Income
- Personal information

...with anyone not involved in the transaction.

Coaching Tip

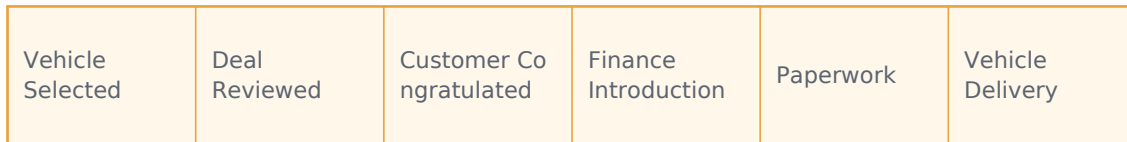
When you're unsure, don't guess. Ask your finance manager.

CHAPTER 6

The Perfect Customer Handoff

Five-Step Transition

1. Confirm purchase details.
1. Congratulate the customer.
1. Introduce the finance manager.
1. Explain what happens next.
1. Thank the customer.

Handoff Flow Diagram

Vehicle Selected → Deal Reviewed → Customer Congratulated → Finance Introduction → Paperwork → Vehicle Delivery

Keep the transition visible and calm. Each step should feel like a continuation of the customer experience—not a sudden change of direction.

CHAPTER 7

F&I Success Checklist

Before Sending the Customer to Finance

Use this final check before the handoff. A complete checklist protects the customer experience and helps your finance partner start with context.

- ☐ Vehicle selected
- ☐ Purchase agreement reviewed
- ☐ Trade completed
- ☐ Questions answered
- ☐ Customer congratulated
- ☐ Finance expectations explained
- ☐ Finance manager introduced
- ☐ Customer thanked

Customer Readiness Checklist

- ☐ Vehicle selected
- ☐ Numbers reviewed
- ☐ Trade appraised
- ☐ Insurance verified
- ☐ Driver's license copied
- ☐ Questions answered
- ☐ Expectations set

CHAPTER 8

Coaching Exercises

Scenario 1

Customer: "I don't want any warranties."

How would you respond?

RECOMMENDED RESPONSE

"That's perfectly okay. Our finance specialist will briefly explain the available options so you have all the information. Then you can decide what works best for you."

Scenario 2

Customer: "Do I have to buy GAP coverage?"

RECOMMENDED RESPONSE

"No. It's optional. Our finance manager will explain how it works and answer any questions so you can make the decision that's right for you."

Manager Coaching Exercise

Observe a salesperson during three customer handoffs.

- ☐ Positive introduction
- ☐ Customer confidence
- ☐ Clear explanation
- ☐ Professional teamwork
- ☐ Smooth transition

Coach's Corner

Customers don't remember every product they were offered. They remember how they were treated.

Coach's Corner — Continued

A confident, respectful handoff to finance reinforces trust and completes the buying experience.

Practice debrief

After each role-play, ask: What made the transition feel clear? Where could the salesperson slow down, explain the next step, or invite a question? Keep feedback specific, respectful, and focused on the customer experience.

BLAMO Closing Principles for F&I Awareness

- ☐ Build confidence before introducing finance.
- ☐ Explain the process, not the products.
- ☐ Let the finance manager handle financing and protection details.
- ☐ Use positive, accurate language.
- ☐ Work as one team to create a seamless customer experience.
- ☐ Protect customer trust through professionalism and integrity.

Close with Clarity—Not Pressure.

BLAMO Closing Principles

F&I Awareness is a trust exercise. Use these principles as a daily standard:

- ☐ Build confidence before introducing finance.
- ☐ Explain the process, not the products.
- ☐ Let the finance manager handle financing and protection details.
- ☐ Use positive, accurate language.
- ☐ Work as one team to create a seamless customer experience.
- ☐ Protect customer trust through professionalism and integrity.
- ☐ Close with Clarity—Not Pressure.

The goal is not pressure. The goal is a clear, respectful next step that lets customers make informed decisions.

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